



KING PRIAM, 2014

The English Touring Opera company is shown here in its production of Michael Tippett's *King Priam*, directed by James Conway and conducted by Michael Rosewell, at the Linbury Studio Theatre, Royal Opera House, London, in 2014.

Taking a stand

After the outbreak of World War II, Tippett was appointed as director of music at Morley College, London ([see box](#)). A lifelong pacifist, he registered as a conscientious objector; in 1942, after refusing to take on civilian duties aiding the war effort, he was taken to court and imprisoned for three months. Following the success of *A Child of Our Time* at its premiere in 1944, however, his pacifism, socialism, and homosexuality were overlooked, and his status so established that he was invited to present a series of talks on BBC radio.

During the 1950s, Tippett lived in Wadhurst, Sussex and in 1960 moved with his partner, Karl Hawker, to Corsham in